

Philip Brocoun

Lead Software Engineer

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Anthropic Claude Certified Architect, Foundations

Profile Details

Hello hiring manager! I'm Philip, and I began my career developing with Ruby on Rails at a startup in NYC in 2007. I have 18+ years of Software Engineering experience, and 8 years as a Lead Engineer. I've climbed from Developer to Senior Developer, to Lead Developer, to Senior Engineering Manager leading a world-wide remote team of twelve.

Today with Claude Code, I build AI-powered software at Olio Apps as a Lead Software Engineer in Portland, OR. I ship BlackLine's new AI Account Recs 3.0 product, and the Daily Reading app for the Grace and Mercy Foundation.

The best way to get to know me better is through my fun website: <https://philipbrocoun.com>

Employment History

Lead Software Engineer at Olio Apps, Portland, OR

May 2025 – Present

- Full-stack consulting projects for clients, with AI-assisted development baked into every phase.
- Shipping **AI Account Recs 3.0** for **BlackLine**, their new AI product for financial account reconciliation.
- Native web/iOS/Android **Daily Reading** app for the **Grace and Mercy Foundation**, like the Kindle app, but fancier.
- TypeScript and React w/ NextJS on the web; Swift & Kotlin for Native Apps. Claude Code & Codex with Herdr for AI assistance.

Senior Software Engineering Manager at Watts Syncta, Portland, OR

June 2019 – April 2025

- Hired 12 software engineers for the development team at Syncta, I built the team from the ground up.
- Built our Ruby on Rails & React webapps, our iOS and Android mobile apps, our APIs, and our AutoPhil Chrome extension.
- Brought our AWS infrastructure up to SOC 2 security compliance with Vanta.
- Hands-on technical lead across every app while managing the team.

Lead Software Engineer at Syncta, Portland, OR

July 2018 – May 2019

Syncta provides mobile software for backflow testers and water purveyors. I'm in charge of our Ruby on Rails app, the JSON API that powers our iOS and Android apps, and the technology powering SynctaOne.

Senior Software Engineer at Merit, New York, NY

February 2014 – March 2016

Merit showcases student achievements at hundreds of colleges and universities. Meritpages.com is the largest Rails app I've ever worked on, comprising eight Rails apps deployed in a services architecture on an AWS Ubuntu Linux cluster.

Software Engineering Consultant at Go Green Ride, Bayonne, NJ

March 2013 – March 2014

Go Green Ride is an eco-friendly ridesharing alternative to Uber. GoGreenRide.com and its accompanying iOS and Android apps use a Ruby on Rails backend that heavily utilizes geolocation services and is deployed on Rackspace using Phusion Passenger.

Software Engineer at readabout.me, New York, NY

December 2012 – February 2014

readabout.me was the predecessor to Merit, focusing primarily on students. The Ruby on Rails app was deployed on Heroku initially, but with its success we quickly outgrew Heroku and switched to AWS.

Full-Stack Developer at readMedia, New York, NY

October 2008 – December 2012

readMedia sends press releases to newspapers via mail merge for its clients all over the country. I upgraded the readMedia.com Ruby on Rails app from version 2 to version 3, helped move it onto AWS, and was one of three developers working full-time on the app for many years.

Analyst at Brightidea, New York, NY

February 2007 – July 2008

Brightidea provides innovation management software-as-a-service. As one of their early employees, I helped with sales, onboarding, consulting, traveling, and running their software.

Math Teacher at NYC Department of Education, New York, NY

September 2006 – June 2007

After getting my Master's degree, I taught 6–8th grade math at the Shuang Wen School (P.S. 184) in Chinatown.

Skills

Technical: AI-assisted development (Claude Code, LLM integration) · TypeScript · React.js & Next.js · Ruby on Rails · GraphQL/REST · PostgreSQL & MySQL · Amazon AWS · Docker · DevOps · Linux & bash · git · Security w/ SOC 2

Leadership: Technical leadership · Mentoring & code review · Agile w/ Jira · Hiring & growth

Hobbies

Poker (\$70,000 in live tournament winnings), Mediterranean food, Chess, Sailing, Guitar, and my dog Toast!

Education

Bachelor of Science (B.S.) in Mathematics at Massachusetts Institute of Technology, Cambridge, MA

2001 – 2005

I have two publications: "Reflections in a Euclidean Space," and "Exploration of Reflection Holograms and Their Fringes With a Scanning Electron Microscope."

Master of Arts (M.A.) in Math Education at New York University, New York, NY

2005 – 2006

I attended NYU through Math for America where I took my theoretical knowledge of mathematics and added practical knowledge of teaching.

References

Scott Becker, CEO of Olio Apps · Diana Lefavi, Director from Watts · Jeremiah Church, Founder from Syncta · Jason Fox, CTO from Merit · Colin Mathews, CEO from Merit

Contact info available on request.